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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT HONOURS FLYDUBAI CREW MEMBERS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Tuesday conferred the First Class Order of Zayed II on the flydubai crew members involved in September's in-flight incident, in recognition of their courageous efforts to ensure the safety of passengers. He is seen here with Flydubai's Captain Smit Machchhar. **SEE ALSO P4**

Wars only lead to further crises: UAE

GARGASH CALLS FOR DIALOGUE; QATAR OFFERS IRAN NEW PEACE PROPOSAL

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE has warned that wars only lead to further crises and called for dialogue and political solutions amid growing regional uncertainty, as Qatar presented Iran with a fresh proposal aimed at ending the conflict with the United States and Israel.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said the increasingly uncertain regional situation demanded restraint, flexibility and rationality rather than further escalation.

"Experiences in the region have demonstrated that wars only lead to further crises, and that diplomacy is the most effective means of safeguarding security and achieving peace and stability," Gargash wrote on X.

He reaffirmed that the UAE's approach remained rooted in wisdom, balance and prioritising dialogue, despite mounting rumours and speculation about renewed confrontation.

Draft peace agreement

The diplomatic appeal came as Qatari mediators delivered a draft peace agreement to Tehran, with Iran expected to respond by the end of the week, Reuters reported.

The proposal outlines a seven-day process requiring Washington and Tehran to take daily confidence-building measures, potentially beginning next week. Several countries could act as guarantors.

However, a senior Iranian official involved in the negotiations described the ideas as unacceptable, highlighting the difficulties facing mediators.

US strikes not ruled out

Meanwhile, US President Donald Trump refused to rule out fresh military strikes against Iran after next week's American midterm elections.

"I can't tell you that," Trump told reporters when asked about possible attacks. "But anything is possible."

Trump claimed Tehran wanted an agreement but suggested Iranian leaders might be delaying negotiations until after the elections.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi warned that any renewed US-Israeli attack on Iran would have devastating economic consequences for the region and beyond.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu struck a more confrontational tone, declaring that Israel had a historic opportunity alongside Trump to eliminate what he described as the Iranian threat "once and for all".

His remarks came amid political uncertainty following Israel's inconclusive parliamentary election.

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President declares January 7 as Zayed the Founder Day

New annual occasion to celebrate Zayed's enduring legacy

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor
KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE will observe January 7 as Zayed the Founder day starting next year.

In a post on X, President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan said the day will be "dedicated to celebrating his enduring legacy, transforming wisdom into action".

"The UAE's Founding Father, the late Sheikh Zayed Bin Sultan Al Nahyan, forever remains in the hearts of the people of the UAE. As he led efforts to establish the Union, laid its foundations, and nurtured its development, his life and legacy were defined by his vision, generosity, and service to humanity. Today, we declare 7 January as Zayed the Founder Day, a new annual national occasion dedicated to celebrating his enduring legacy, transforming wisdom into action, and ensuring these values continue to inspire our nation on its steadfast path of progress towards the future," he said.

The timing of the day at the beginning of the year is intentional. As schools, workplaces and institutions begin a new year, January 7 gives the people of the UAE a national moment to reconnect with Sheikh Zayed's values, renew their commitment to the principles he embodied throughout his life, and carry them forward through the year.



ABU DHABI

Ethara CEO: Abu Dhabi F1 Grand Prix 2026 is happening

Nothing has changed, says Al Noaimi | P-1

Sharjah closes beaches to safeguard against oil spill

Specialist teams and relevant authorities taking necessary measures

Authorities have urged members of the public and beachgoers to comply with official instructions and follow safety guidance issued by the relevant teams.

SHARJAH

BY SURABHI VASUNDHARADEVI
Social Media Reporter

Beaches across Sharjah city have been temporarily closed as a precautionary measure to prevent marine pollution caused by an oil spill from a tanker at sea, the Sharjah Government Media Bureau has announced.

Specialist teams and relevant authorities in the emirate are taking necessary measures to protect the coastline and prevent the pollution from reaching the beaches.

The temporary closure is part of proactive precautionary measures aimed at safeguarding the beaches and ensuring public safety amid the risk of marine pollution.

Authorities have urged members of the public and beachgoers to comply with official instructions and follow safety guidance issued by the relevant teams.

The public has also been advised to obtain updates and information through official channels and avoid circulating rumours.

On October 24, the Ras Al Khaimah Public Services Department, in coordination with Ras Al Khaimah Police General Headquarters, announced the immediate closure of all public beaches across the emirate until further notice as a temporary measure to safeguard public safety.

All beaches and coastal areas in Umm Al Quwain were have also been closed temporarily as a precaution while technical teams complete their assessments. The municipality also began massive cleanup operations.

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